Paradiem

The Morning Brief

JULY 11, 2026

Weekend Edition

S&P 500 reportedly notched a chip-led weekly advance of ~1.3% (still below the June 2 all-time high) as the U.S.-Iran ceasefire reportedly lapsed but talks reportedly continued.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	NASDAQ (FRI CLOSE)	WTI (USO FRI)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	FEAR & GREED (CNN)
$754.95 · ↑~1.3% on the week · below June 2 record	$725.51 · chip-led weekly bid	$108.70 · ↓0.28% Fri · weekly gain per Reuters	~$62,000–$64,000 · ↑~2.8% wk per Yahoo	~48 · Neutral per CNN · data drop returned crypto fallback (26)

SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review

THE WEEK REPORTEDLY BELONGED TO THE CHIP COMPLEX EVEN AS THE U.S.-IRAN THEATER WIDENED: PER REUTERS AND CNBC COVERAGE, THE S&P 500 REPORTEDLY CLOSED FRIDAY AT $754.95 (↑0.43% FRI, REPORTEDLY ↑~1.3% ON THE WEEK PER REUTERS — REPORTEDLY STILL BELOW THE REPORTED JUNE 2 ALL-TIME HIGH) AS META REPORTEDLY RALLIED ~15% ON THE WEEK PER BBN TIMES / REUTERS ON THE REPORTED IN-HOUSE "IRIS" AI CHIP ROADMAP AND NVDA REPORTEDLY CLOSED ↑4.03% AT $210.96 FRIDAY AFTER REPORTEDLY CLEARING $200 WEDNESDAY AND $210 FRIDAY PER THE DATA DROP; THE REPORTED SK HYNIX ADR DEBUT REPORTEDLY SURGED ~13% IN A REPORTED $26.5B LISTING PER REUTERS, REPORTEDLY THE LARGEST OF THE YEAR

For FCI's framework, the week reportedly delivered a two-leg narrative: (1) an AI-capex bid that reportedly absorbed the reported Iran escalation and (2) a Friday-close broadening as Materials (XLB ↑1.25%), Staples (XLP ↑1.11%), and Comm Svcs (XLC ↑1.02%) reportedly led the reported Friday tape per the data drop. For the FCI Growth-Hybrid sleeve, NVDA reportedly finished the week at $210.96 (↑4.03% Friday) after reportedly clearing $200 Wednesday per prior brief coverage; AMD reportedly closed ↑2.04% at $557.89 Friday and reportedly ended the week reflecting the reported Goldman PT raise to $640 from $450 per Yahoo. The reported chip-equipment complex reportedly captured a mid-week bid (LRCX reportedly ↑6.01% Thursday to $353.17, then reportedly ↓0.80% Friday to $350.33 per the data drop) on the reported Meta "Iris" AI chip headline per Reuters. Precious metals reportedly cooled Friday (GLD ↓0.31%, SLV ↓0.35%) and TLT reportedly closed effectively flat at $84.47. Carson's SPY $645.80 support remains active per levels.json, well-removed from Friday's reported intraday range of $748.10–$755.42 per the data drop.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	$754.95 · ↑0.43% Fri · ↑~1.3% wk per Reuters · below June 2 record
NASDAQ (FRI CLOSE)	$725.51 · ↑0.31% Fri per data drop
DOW (FRI CLOSE)	$525.78 · ↑0.30% Fri per data drop
TOP FCI MOVERS (FRI)	SUPV ↑6.36% · NVDA ↑4.03% · STLD ↑2.86% · BKH ↑2.63% · ETHA ↑2.58% per data drop
BOTTOM FCI MOVERS (FRI)	MARA ↓4.69% · FTNT ↓3.80% · HUT ↓3.77% · HRMY ↓3.59% · MRVL ↓3.07% per data drop
BITCOIN (WEEKLY)	Reportedly ↑~2.8% wk per Yahoo · ETF inflows reportedly snapped 10-day outflow streak per Reuters
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 · active · far from Fri intraday range $748.10–$755.42

PER REUTERS COVERAGE OF FRIDAY'S REPORTED UAE EXPORT RULE CHANGE, THE U.S. REPORTEDLY EASED EXPORT CONTROLS ON THE UAE FOR REPORTED NVIDIA AI CHIPS, MILITARY EQUIPMENT, AND REPORTED COMMERCIAL SATELLITES PER BLOOMBERG / REUTERS — REPORTED G42 AND CORE42 PLUS REPORTED U.S. FIRMS (AMAZON, APPLE, XAI) REPORTEDLY NO LONGER REQUIRE LICENSES FOR REPORTED AI CHIPS AND SERVERS PER THE FEDERAL REGISTER; THE REPORTED MOVE REPORTEDLY UNDERSCORES THE UAE'S REPORTED ROLE IN THE U.S. IRAN STRATEGY EVEN AS THE REPORTED CEASEFIRE FORMALLY LAPSED PER CNN AND REUTERS

For FCI's framework, the reported UAE export easing reportedly compounds the reported Meta "Iris" chip news as a materially constructive read-across for the FCI Chip-Equipment complex (LRCX $350.33, KEYS $322.05, TEL $200.36 Fri per data drop) and the reported AI-capex bid (NVDA $210.96 ↑4.03% Fri) even as MRVL reportedly closed ↓3.07% at $235.81 Friday per the data drop and CRDO reportedly gave back ↓2.96% to $257.79. The reported UAE opening also reportedly reinforces the reported Middle East realignment thesis: as the reported Iran theater reportedly stayed hot, U.S. commercial and defense export access reportedly widened for reported Gulf partners. DAL reportedly reported Q2 EPS $1.56 vs $1.47 estimate per Alphastreet (a reported 6.1% beat) with revenue $19.76B (reportedly ↑19% YoY) and reaffirmed the reported full-year EPS guide of $6.50–$7.50 per Alphastreet — a materially constructive industrials read-across even though DAL is not an FCI position. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

The week reportedly showed the AI-capex bid can reportedly absorb a widening Iran theater; the Friday close reportedly rolls into a packed calendar (CPI Tuesday, Warsh testimony Tue/Wed, banks kick off Tuesday) that will reportedly test whether the bid extends. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — U.S.-Iran Ceasefire Reportedly Lapsed Late in the Week per CNN and Al Jazeera With Trump Reportedly Confirming the Reported Memorandum of Understanding "Over" but Talks Reportedly Continuing per Reuters; The Reported Strait of Hormuz Reportedly Emerged as the Key Sticking Point per CNN as Fresh U.S. Sanctions Reportedly Followed the Reported Iran Hormuz Vessel Attacks; Pakistan and Qatar Reportedly Working to Restart the Reported Technical Track per Al Jazeera

PER CNN LIVE-BLOG AND REUTERS COVERAGE OF THE REPORTED WEEK'S MIDDLE EAST DEVELOPMENTS, THE REPORTED U.S. STRUCK ~90 IRANIAN TARGETS WEDNESDAY PER REUTERS, IRAN REPORTEDLY RETALIATED OVERNIGHT THURSDAY WITH REPORTED DRONE STRIKES ON BAHRAIN (REPORTED FUEL STORAGE), KUWAIT (REPORTED PATRIOT BATTERY), AND QATAR (REPORTED SATELLITE / EARLY-WARNING) PLUS A REPORTED 10-BALLISTIC-MISSILE SALVO ON JORDAN'S AL AZRAQ AIR BASE PER TIMES OF ISRAEL; TRUMP REPORTEDLY WARNED REPORTED ADDITIONAL STRIKES COULD TARGET IRAN'S KHARG ISLAND EXPORT TERMINAL PER REUTERS AND REPORTED MISSILES AIMED AT IRAN IF TEHRAN TARGETS THE U.S. PRESIDENT PER THE DATA DROP HEADLINES; REPORTED IRANIAN REFINERY FIRE (WESTERN IRAN) REPORTEDLY CONTAINED PER REUTERS

For FCI's framework, the reported cross-asset composition into the weekend reportedly reads as a market pricing the reported Iran theater as tactical rather than structural: WTI (USO) reportedly closed Friday at $108.70 (↓0.28%) and Brent (BNO) at $42.15 (↓0.05%), a materially different composition than the Wednesday-into-Thursday spike (Brent reportedly settled ↑5.43% at $78.19 Wednesday per Reuters per prior brief coverage). Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, U.S. pain at the pump reportedly worsened after more U.S.-Iran fighting reportedly lifted oil prices — a signal that the reported energy premium reportedly matters materially for the reported CPI print Tuesday even as the reported Fed's Williams reportedly said energy prices have already peaked despite the reported new Iran fighting per prior brief coverage. For the FCI Refiner sleeve, VLO reportedly closed ↓0.20% at $280.69 Friday per the data drop (reportedly holding Wednesday's reported ↑6.26% bid), and DVN reportedly closed ↑0.50% at $42.23; CVX reportedly closed ↑1.35% at $176.40. For the FCI Defense sleeve, LMT reportedly closed ↑0.96% at $523.22 Friday and GD ↑0.12% at $375.06 per the data drop — a reported recovery consistent with the reported ongoing theater and per Yahoo coverage in the data drop, reported NATO allies pledging over $50B into defense supports the reported LMT/GD program backdrop. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, U.S. officials reportedly insist Iran commit to stopping Hormuz attacks — a signal that the reported Hormuz-passage assurance reportedly frames the reported Doha technical track. **The physical world matters.**

PER REUTERS COVERAGE IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, THE U.S. REPORTEDLY MADE IT EASIER TO EXPORT NVIDIA AI CHIPS AND REPORTED MILITARY EQUIPMENT TO THE UAE PER THE FEDERAL REGISTER — A REPORTED ALLIANCE-WIDENING MOVE THAT REPORTEDLY COMPOUNDS THE REPORTED CHIP-COMPLEX BID EVEN AS THE IRAN THEATER REPORTEDLY STAYS LIVE; PER REUTERS' "WALL ST WEEK AHEAD" COVERAGE IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, INVESTORS REPORTEDLY GRAPPLE WITH A REPORTED PACKED WEEK OF EARNINGS, CPI, AND IRAN HEADLINES AHEAD

For FCI's framework, the reported UAE opening reportedly reinforces the reported Middle East realignment thesis at the reported policy layer: as the reported Iran ceasefire reportedly lapsed, the reported U.S. commercial and defense export access reportedly widened for reported Gulf partners — a reported constructive item for the FCI AI-capex bid (NVDA, AMD, LRCX, KEYS, TEL) and reported defense sleeve (LMT, GD). Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, BlackRock reportedly listed its reported top 10 geopolitical risks — a reported framing item for the FCI Consumer Staples read-across (CL ↑1.35% Fri to $92.24 per data drop) into next week's reported CPI print. Per CNN and Reuters coverage, mediators Pakistan and Qatar reportedly working to restart the reported technical track; if the reported Doha channel reopens, the reported energy-premium retrace reportedly extends; if it stalls, the reported Kharg Island escalation risk reportedly returns to the reported oil bid. **Think Like an Owner.**

CEASEFIRE STATUS	Reportedly “over” per Trump; talks reportedly continue per Reuters
HORMUZ STICKING POINT	Reportedly the key ceasefire dispute per CNN
MEDIATORS	Pakistan & Qatar reportedly working to restart talks per Al Jazeera
WTI (FRI CLOSE)	USO $108.70 · ↓0.28% Fri · weekly gain per Reuters
BRENT (FRI CLOSE)	BNO $42.15 · ↓0.05% Fri per data drop
UAE EXPORT EASING	Reportedly license-free access to AI chips per Bloomberg / Reuters
TRUMP KHARG WARNING	Reportedly warned reported future strikes could target Kharg per Reuters

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — Reported June CPI Tuesday July 14 at 7:30 AM CT per BLS Calendar Is the Reported Anchor Print; Chair Warsh Reportedly Testifies Before the House Financial Services Committee at 9 AM CT Tuesday and the Senate Banking Committee at 9 AM CT Wednesday per Reported Congressional Coverage — the Reported First Warsh Public Rate-Path Reset Since the Reported First Warsh-Chaired FOMC Minutes; Reported Big-Bank Earnings Reportedly Begin Tuesday (JPM, C, WFC, GS, and BAC Reportedly Tuesday July 14; MS Reportedly Wednesday July 15) per BAC IR / CNBC Coverage in Kiplinger; Reported June PPI Wednesday, Reported June Retail Sales Thursday per BLS/Census Calendars. For FCI’s framework, the reported CPI print reportedly frames whether the reported Iran-driven energy premium reportedly bled into headline inflation; per CNBC coverage in Kiplinger, the reported print reportedly is expected to reportedly show some moderation after a reported June crude decline. Chair Warsh’s reported testimony reportedly is the reported first opportunity for a public rate-path recalibration since the reported Warsh-chaired minutes reportedly framed a 9-versus-9 split on 2026 rate direction per prior brief coverage. The reported Big-Bank kickoff reportedly clarifies the reported consumer-credit backdrop for the FCI Dividend sleeve’s reported financial exposure (SYF $72.44 ↑1.22% Fri per data drop after Wednesday’s reported ↓9.61% give-back). *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. FCI Position Watch — FAST Reportedly Reports Q2 Monday Pre-Market per FAST IR — The First FCI Dividend-Sleeve Q2 Print This Cycle; Reported Consensus Reportedly Frames the Industrial Distribution Read-Across per Prior Brief Coverage. STLD Reportedly Reports Q2 July 21 per Company Release, With STLD Reportedly Closing ↑2.86% at $228.42 Friday per the Data Drop After Wednesday’s Reported ↓2.93% Give-Back. QCOM Reportedly Traded ↓1.02% Friday to $189.16 per the Data Drop After Yahoo Coverage in the Data Drop Headlines Reportedly Framed the QCOM Index Removal. For FCI’s framework, FAST’s reported print reportedly tests whether reported industrial-distribution demand reportedly firmed into Q2 as reported Fed cut-odds recalibrated post-payrolls; per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, FAST reportedly announced a reported cash dividend and reported share repurchase activity ahead of the print, and Morgan Stanley reportedly maintained Equal-Weight with a PT raise to $48. Per Yahoo coverage in the data drop, VLO reportedly captured a reported constructive framing on reported strong fuel demand and reported elevated crack spreads — a reported read-across for the reported Refiner sleeve’s reported energy-premium capture. **Avoid Erosion.**

3. Digital-Sleeve Weekend Watch — Bitcoin Reportedly Traded ~$62,000–$64,000 Into the Weekend per Yahoo/ Benzinga, Reportedly ↑~2.8% on the Week per Yahoo; Per Reuters Coverage in the Data Drop Headlines, a Reported New Version of the CLARITY Act Could Reportedly Emerge Next Week per Yahoo Coverage in the Data Drop; MARA Reportedly Closed ↓4.69% at $12.60 Friday After Wednesday-Thursday's Reported Bid on the Reported HIF Texas 1,200-Acre Site Deal (Reportedly Up to 2 GW by April 2028 per StockTitan/MARA IR) per the Data Drop. For FCI's Digital Assets and Growth-Hybrid sleeves, per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, U.S. spot Bitcoin ETFs reportedly snapped a reported 10-day outflow streak with a reported $221.7M inflow per Reuters, the reported largest daily haul in two months — a signal that reported institutional positioning reportedly re-engaged into the reported CLARITY Act cycle. IBIT reportedly closed ↑1.17% at $36.23 and ETHA ↑2.58% at $13.53 Friday per the data drop. Per Yahoo coverage in the data drop headlines, HOOD reportedly closed ↓2.73% at $111.97 Friday even as Kraken reportedly targeted reported retail traders with reported agentic trading ahead of the reported Kraken IPO — a reported competitive framing item for HOOD's reported retail moat. *The physical world matters.*

4. Levels & Housekeeping — Carson's SPY $645.80 Support Remains Active per levels.json; Friday's Reported Intraday Range on the S&P 500 Reportedly Was $748.10–$755.42 per the Data Drop, Well-Removed From the Reported Support Level. The Reported CNN Fear & Greed Index Reportedly Sits at ~48 (Neutral) per CNN Coverage; The Data Drop Reportedly Returned the Reported Crypto Fallback Value (26) — A Reported CNN Endpoint Miss to Flag per CLAUDE.md. The Reported Fed Communication Window Reportedly Continues Through the Reported July 29 FOMC per the Federal Reserve Calendar, With Chair Warsh's Reported Testimony Tue/Wed the Reported Live Rate-Path Signal. For FCI's framework, the reported Friday close reportedly leaves the reported S&P 500 reportedly well above every reported 50/100/200-day moving average per prior brief coverage even as the index reportedly sits below the reported June 2 all-time high; the reported Warsh testimony reportedly frames whether the reported inflation-tinted view reportedly holds into the reported July 29 dot-plot recalibration. **Think Like an Owner.**